PPP-C-26B
January 20, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. PPP-C-26A
August 14, 1968

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CANNED BAKED, CANNED STEAMED, AND CANNED STEAMED AND RETORTED SUBSISTENCE ITEMS, PACKAGING AND PACKING OF

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the packaging, packing, labeling, and marking requirements for canned baked, canned steamed, and canned steamed and retorted subsistence items for use by the Armed Forces as components of Operational Rations, and for the use of other Federal agencies, as applicable.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-C-96	-	Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-101	-	Preservation, Packaging and Packing Materials: Test Procedures
FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

FSC 8920
PACK

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(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606).

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. All packaging and packing materials shall conform to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder. The materials from which cans are made shall be of good commercial quality and as herein specified.

3.2 Workmanship. The filled and sealed cans shall be clean and free from defects such as rust, dents, torn liners or discs, improper closure and other defects affecting the serviceability of the cans.

3.3 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

3.3.1 Level A. The product shall be filled into an open-top style round, metal can, with soldered side seam and grease-resistant compound lined double seamed ends. Beaded cans are not acceptable. The cans shall be made throughout from not less than commercial 0.25 pound electrolytic tin plate per base box (see 4.4.1). Sealing of canned items after baking shall be timed so as to meet the requirements of 3.3.1.4 and table IV. Cans of steamed and retorted items shall be hermetically sealed after steaming and before retorting so as to meet the requirements of 3.3.1.4 and table IV. Vacuum shall be achieved by thermal means only. As specified (see 6.1), can sizes for the various products shall have the net weights of product as specified in tables I and IA. The compound in the can ends shall meet the requirements as specified in 3.3.1.1. Cans shall be lined as specified in 3.3.1.2. The base plate weight and temper of the various size cans shall be as specified in 3.3.1.3. The cans shall be coated overall inside with an enamel suitable for the product and shall be coated outside with a coating complying with type I of TT-C-495. The compound lining in the can ends with the enamel for the various products shall be capable of withstanding temperatures as specified in table II without failure to perform the intended function. When specified (see 6.1), the can shall be key-opening style and a corrosion-resistant key shall be attached to the bottom of the can by soldering or welding, using a noncorrosive flux.

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TABLE I. Baked product, can size, and net weight of finished product

Can size	Raisin cake and raisin nut cake	Fruitcake	Cinnamon nut roll	Pound cake	Orange nut roll	Chocolate nut roll
300 x 200	4-1/4 oz. (120.5 g)	5 oz. (141.7 g)	4 oz. (113.4 g)	2-1/5 oz. (62.4 g)	4 oz. (113.4 g)	3-1/2 oz. (99.2 g)
300 x 308		9 oz. (255.1 g)	7-1/2 oz. (212.6 g)	4-1/2 oz. (127.6 g)	7-3/4 oz. (219.7 g)	6-3/4 oz. (191.4 g)
300 x 407	10-3/4 oz. (304.8 g)	12 oz. (340.2 g)	9-1/2 oz. (269.3 g)		9-1/2 oz. (269.3 g)	9-1/2 oz. (269.3 g)
307 x 409				7-3/4 oz (219.7 g)		
401 x 411	19-1/2 oz. (552.8 g)	24 oz. (680.4 g)	18-1/2 oz. (524.5 g)	11-1/2 oz. (326.0 g)	19-1/2 oz. (552.8 g)	17-1/2 oz. (496.1 g)

TABLE IA. Steamed and steamed and retorted product, can size, and net weight of finished product

Can size	Raisin cake and raisin nut cake	Chocolate nut roll	Orange nut roll	Pudding	
				Type I & II	Type III
300 x 200	4-1/4 oz. (120.5 g)	3-1/2 oz. (99.2 g)	4 oz. (113.4 g)	4-3/4 oz. (134.7 g)	5 oz. (141.7 g)
300 x 308		6-3/4 oz. (191.4 g)	7-3/4 oz. (219.7 g)		
300 x 407	10-3/4 oz. (304.8 g)	9-1/2 oz. (269.3 g)	9-1/2 oz. (269.3 g)	12 oz. (340.2 g)	12-1/2 oz. (354.4 g)
401 x 411	19-1/2 oz. (552.8 g)	17-1/2 oz. (496.1 g)	19-1/2 oz. (552.8 g)	22-1/2 oz. (637.9 g)	22 oz. (623.7 G)

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TABLE II. Product temperature to be withstood during processing

Products	Process Temperature (°F.) and (°C.) Baking	Steaming	Retorting
Pound cake	375°F (191°C)		
Cinnamon nut roll	375°F (191°C)		
Fruit cake	375°F (191°C)		
Raisin cake and raisin nut cake	375°F (191°C)	212°F (100°C)	250°F (121°C)
Chocolate nut roll	320°F (160°C)	212°F (100°C)	
Orange nut roll	325°F (163°C)	212°F (100°C)	
Pudding		212°F (100°C)	250°F (121°C)

3.3.1.1 Can seam compound. The compound used in the ends of the cans shall be as recommended by the can manufacturer for the specific product to be produced and shall be compatible with the methods of processing employed by the processor of the product. Notwithstanding the fact that the compound used in the ends of the cans is that recommended by the can manufacturer, the compound shall withstand the method of processing employed and shall meet the requirements stated herein. The compound shall have sufficient flexibility and adhesion to provide a hermetic seal and shall show no evidence of extrusion out of the double seam, except that the compound may appear at the junction of the side seam and double seam, provided it does not adhere to the product. The compound shall also be resistant to the oils and fats inherent in the product to be packaged and to the enamel used in preparing the can for processing.

3.3.1.2 Can liners. As specified for the product, as listed in table III, can sizes 300 by 308, 300 by 407, 307 by 409, and 401 by 411, shall have the can bottoms lined with a die-cut circular disc and the sides of the can shall be lined with a die-cut sheet. The dimensions of the die-cut discs and the liner for the various size cans shall be as indicated in table IIIA. Discs and liners shall be made from a silicone-treated vegetable parchment paper. The untreated sheet shall have a basis weight of 35 pounds per ream (24 by 36 - 500) (57 g/m^2) and shall be treated with a minimum of 2 pounds per ream (24 by 36 - 500) (3.25 g/m^2) of silicone. For can size 300 by 200, the liners shall be a fluted paper cup made from either vegetable parchment or white glassine having a minimum basis weight of 25 pounds per ream (24 by 36 - 500) (40.6 g/m^2). The cup shall be of sufficient size to completely cover the bottom and sides of the can (recommended size: 2-3/4 inches (6.99 cm) in diameter by 1-5/8 inches (4.1 cm) high), with no top flare. Basis weight of paper shall be tested as specified in 4.4.3.

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TABLE III. Product, parchment used

Item name	Parchment used
Pound cake	Yes
Cinnamon nut roll	Yes *
Fruit cake	Yes
Chocolate nut roll	Yes
Orange nut roll	Yes
Pudding	Yes
Raisin cake and raisin nut cake	Yes

* For size 300 by 200 can, body liner is not necessary, but a die-cut 2-3/4 inch (6.99 cm) diameter disc shall be placed in the bottom of the can before filling. Paper shall be as specified in 3.3.1.2. Alternatively, for all can sizes for cinnamon nut roll, interior enamel possessing adequate product release characteristics may be used in lieu of the paper disc and liner, provided that not more than 5 percent of the product adheres to the interior of the can.

TABLE IIIA. Can sizes and dimension of parchment liners and discs

Can size	Liner dimensions in inches and metric equivalents (length by width)	Disc dimensions in inches and metric equivalents (diameter)
300 x 308	8-15/16 by 3 (22.7 cm by 7.6 cm)	2-3/4 (6.99 cm)
300 x 407	8-15/16 by 3-7/8 (22.7 cm by 9.8 cm)	2-3/4 (6.99 cm)
307 x 409	10-1/4 by 4 (26.0 cm by 10.2 cm)	3-1/8 (7.9 cm)
401 x 411	12-1/8 by 4-1/8 (30.8 cm by 10.5 cm)	3-3/4 (9.5 cm)

3.3.1.3 Base plate weight and temper of metal base plate.

3.3.1.3.1 For baked items. The bodies and ends of the cans shall be fabricated from metal having a base plate weight and temper adequate to withstand a 29.9 inch vacuum.

3.3.1.3.2 For steamed items. The bodies and ends of the size 300 by 200, 300 by 308, and 300 by 407 cans shall be fabricated from metal having a base plate weight and temper adequate to withstand a 15 inch (50.3 kPa) vacuum. The bodies and ends of the size 401 by 411 cans shall be fabricated from metal meeting the same requirements for the 401 by 411 can as specified in 3.3.1.3.1.

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3.3.1.4 Vacuum requirements. The individual items shall be processed as specified in each respective product specification and shall achieve the minimum internal can vacuums in the baked and steamed and retorted items as specified in table IV. Each and every baked item can shall be examined for gross leakers in accordance with 3.3.1.5. This requirement supplements the can vacuum test and in no way shall it be construed as revoking the minimum gage vacuums specified in table IV.

TABLE IV. Product and minimum internal vacuum requirements (gage vacuum)

Baked		Steamed, and steamed and retorted	
Product	Vacuum in inches of mercury and absolute pressure in metric equivalents	Product	Vacuum in inches of mercury and absolute pressure in metric equivalents
		Chocolate nut roll	10 in. (67.2 kPa)
Fruit cake	25 in. (16.5 kPa)		
Orange nut roll	25 in. (16.5 kPa)	Orange nut roll	10 in. (67.2 kPa)
Cinnamon nut roll	25 in. (16.5 kPa)		
Pound cake	25 in. (16.5 kPa)	Pudding	10 in. (67.2 kPa)
Raisin cake and raisin nut cake	25 in. (16.5 kPa)	Raisin cake and raisin nut cake	10 in. (67.2 kPa)

3.3.1.5 Determination of gross leakers for baked items. The procedure is prescribed for the purpose of removing gross leakers following canning and the examination in table X does not apply. The determination shall be conducted in the following manner: Prior to being packed into shipping container, each cooled can shall be tested for vacuum by means of a flip (or equivalent) test. Cans having less than 16 inches (46.9 kPa) gage vacuum (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches of mercury), as determined by the flip (or equivalent) test method, will not be acceptable. This requirement is supplemental and should not be construed as revoking the 25 inch (16.5 kPa) minimum gage vacuum requirements of product.

3.3.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 3.3.1 except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

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3.4 Packing, level C.

3.4.1 Military agencies (for shipment to ration assembly). The cans of the product, in the number and arrangement as specified in table V and showing no evidence of moisture shall be packed in containers which insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rate for such supplies. The containers shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

TABLE V. Can sizes, number and arrangement in shipping case

		Arrangement		
Can size	Number per case	Length	Width	Depth
300 by 200	96	6	4	4
300 by 308	72	6	4	3
300 by 407	48	6	4	2
307 by 409	48	6	4	2
401 by 411	24	4	3	2

3.4.2 Civil agencies. The packaged product shall be packed in containers which insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The containers shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

3.5 Labeling and marking.

3.5.1 Military agencies.

3.5.1.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the date of pack (day, month, and year) shall be legibly printed, hand stamped, or lithographed on one end or on the body of the can, in numerals. Embossing or impressing is not permitted. For canned baked items, except fruit cake, a code letter indicating dough batch shall be included on one end or on the body of the can. Fruitcake shall be coded with a single code for all batches during each 8 hour shift.

3.5.1.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

3.5.2 Civil agencies.

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3.5.2.1 Cans. Any labeling that complies with Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, and Regulations promulgated Thereunder for its enforcement is acceptable. In addition, the date of pack (day, month, and year) shall be legibly printed, hand stamped, or lithographed on one end or on the body of the can, in numerals. Embossing or impressing is not permitted. For canned baked items, a code letter indicating dough batch shall be included on one end or on body of can.

3.5.2.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of FED-STD-123 and such other information as specified by individual agencies.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 Testing of components. Testing of components described in this specification and changes in the testing of components listed in subsidiary specifications shall be as shown in table VI. Results shall apply to the lot average unless otherwise specified in subsidiary specifications. Test failure shall indicate unacceptable components and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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TABLE VI. Testing of components

Component	Sample unit 2/	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	Characteristics	Results reported	Test reference & rqmts. paragraph
Cans and lids 1/	1 can and lid	Cans	S-1	Tinplate	Nearest 0.01 lb. (0.07 kg)/ base box	3.3 and 4.4.1
Can liners	50 sheets and disks or 50 cups	Sheets and disks or cups	S-1	Basis weight of paper	Nearest 1 lb. (0.45 kg)/ ream	3.3.1.2 and 4.4.3

1/ Exterior can coating (when required) and can label shall be tested in accordance with the applicable subsidiary specifications, except that tests shall be performed on the same cans submitted for tinplate testing, with additional cans as required to complete the sample plan of TT-C-495.

2/ For cans with height or diameter dimensions of 2 inches or less respectively, the sample unit shall be two cans with two lids.

4.2.3 Process examination (for baked products only). Examination of baked items shall be performed to determine conformance to 3.3.1.5. Nonconformance to specified procedures and controls for elimination of gross leakers shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of finished products.

4.3 Inspection of the end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with table VIII through XI and paragraphs 4.3.1 through 4.3.3. The inspection levels, sample units, expression of lot sizes and the acceptable quality levels (AQLs) for the foregoing tables shall be as shown in table VII. AQLs shall be expressed in defects per hundred units for tables VIII and XI and expressed as percent defective for tables IX and X.

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TABLE VII. Acceptable quality levels

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs			
				Major A	Major B	Minor	Total
VIII	I	1 filled and sealed primary container	Primary container	0.25	1.5	6.5	--
IX	S-4	1 filled and sealed primary container	Primary container	--	--	2.5	--
X	S-2	1 filled and sealed primary container	Primary container	--	1.5	6.5	--
XI	S-4	1 filled and sealed primary container	Primary container	--	2.5	10.0	--

TABLE VIII. External examination of primary container

Category			Defects
Major A	Major B	Minor	
101			Springer, flipper, or swell
102			False seam or improper seam
	151		Not type, style, or size specified
	152		Severe dent
	153		Severe paneling, buckling, or collapsed cans
	154		Cable cut
	155		Pitted rust 1/
	156		Band on can not completely scored 2/
	157		Key missing or not securely attached 2/
	158		Wet

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TABLE VIII. External examination of primary container (cont'd)

Category			Defects
Major A	Major B	Minor	
		201	Not clean 3/
		202	Moderate dent
		204	Tongue of scored band completely soldered down 2/

1/ Rust that can be removed by wiping with a soft cloth will not be considered as pitted rust.

2/ Applicable only when key-opening can is specified (see 6.1).

3/ Cans showing a very thin film of grease which is discernible to the touch but not readily discernible visually are considered to be clean.

TABLE IX. Examination for net weight 1/ 2/

Category	Defects
Minor	
201	Net weight more than 5 percent under specified weight for containers having a net weight of 5 ounces (141.7 g) or less 2/
202	Net weight more than 2 percent under specified weight for containers having a net weight more than 5 ounces (141.7 g) 2/

1/ Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicate a lot average net weight less than specified weight required in table I and IA.

2/ Weigh to nearest 0.1 gram and report to nearest whole gram.

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TABLE X. Examination for vacuum (4.4.2 and table IV)

Category		Defects
Major B	Minor	
151		Less than 24 (19.9 kPa) but not less than 22 inches (26.7 kPa) 1/ 2/
152		Less than 10 inches (67.2 kPa) 3/
	201	Less than 25 (16.6 kPa) but not less than 24 inches (19.9 kPa) 2/

1/ Any can showing vacuum of less than 22 inches (26.7 kPa) shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot. (Baked products only).

2/ Applicable to Pound Cake, Cinnamon Nut Roll, Fruit Cake, Bread, Raisin Cake, Chocolate Nut Roll, Raisin Nut Cake, and Orange Nut Roll. (Baked products only).

3/ Applicable to Chocolate Nut Roll, Orange Nut Roll, Pudding, Raisin Cake, and Raisin Nut Cake. (Steamed, or steamed and retorted products, as indicated).

TABLE XI. Examination for interior packaging characteristics 1/

Category		Defects
Major B	Minor	
151		Interior enamel coating of can missing or incomplete or blistered
152		Interior enamel coating of can easily abraded or peeled with finger tip
153		Parchment liner or glassine cup missing or not as specified
154		Extrusion of seaming compound visible on interior of can or lid excluding junction of side seam and double seam

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TABLE XI. Examination for interior packaging characteristics 1/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
155		Rusted
	201	Tear 1/2 inch (13 mm) or more in length through parchment liner, disc, or cup
156		More than 5 percent of the surface of the cinnamon nut roll adhering to interior surface of can 2/

1/ Make interior examination of can after removing product from can.

2/ When can has been provided with product release enamel.

4.3.1 Examination of can labeling. When can labeling is required to be in accordance with MIL-L-1497, examination of cans for labeling shall be in accordance with that specification.

4.3.2 Examination of can coating. Examination of exterior coating of cans shall be in accordance with TT-C-495.

4.3.3 Examination of shipping container. The filled and closed shipping container shall be examined for marking and arrangement of contents when applicable. The sample size shall be the number of shipping containers indicated by inspection level S-3. The acceptable quality levels expressed as percent defective shall be 2.5 for Major B defects and 6.5 for Minor defects. The lot size shall be expressed in terms of shipping containers. Classification of defects shall be as shown in table XII.

TABLE XII. Examination of shipping containers

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
151		Marking omitted, incomplete, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
	201	Any nonconformance with the requirements or number or arrangement of cans as specified in table V

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4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Tin coating weights. Tin coating weights shall be determined by any method specified in PPP-C-96.

4.4.2 Vacuum. After processing, sample cans shall be selected which are free of dents or other visible damage. The cans and contents shall be allowed to reach a temperature of 75° ± 5° F (24°C ± 3°C). The vacuum reading shall then be taken with a puncture-type vacuum gage, making the puncture as near as possible to the double seam to minimize error due to distortion of the end. For normal inspection purposes, a correction of 1 inch shall be added to the gage reading for each 1,000 feet above sea level at which the determination is made. The following is an example of a normal inspection vacuum determination:

	Inches in Mercury
Vacuum reading	8
Altitude correction (2,000 ft.)	2
Corrected vacuum	10

4.4.3 Paper test. Basis weight of paper shall be tested in accordance with method 5022 of FED-STD-101.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Not applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size of can required (see 3.3.1).
(c) When key-opening style can is required (see 3.3.1).
(d) Level of packaging required (see 3.3).

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MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - SM, MD
Navy - MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

AGRI - AMS, APS
GSA - FSS
VA - DMS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8920-0342

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